PCS-2024: REFORMED SYSTEM, REMARKABLE RESULTS



The results released by UPPSC reflect a record rise in women's representation, their dominance at the top ranks, strong presence in key positions, and reforms in the selection process—collectively presenting a clear picture of a transforming administrative framework.

The final result of the PCS-2024 examination, declared by the Uttar Pradesh Public Service Commission (UPPSC) late on the evening of March 30, has proven to be historic in many respects. This year's list not only marked a strong and significant presence of women but also underscored their supremacy at the top, establishing that in competitive examinations, they are not just achieving parity but, in many cases, surpassing it. Out of the total 932 selected candidates, 319 are women, accounting for 34.22 percent. This is the highest figure in the past decade and is being regarded as a significant milestone in the march towards women's empowerment.

What stands out most in this success story is the clear dominance of women in the top rankings as well. Neha Panchal from Delhi secured the top position, while Ananya Trivedi from Raebareli ranked second. The presence of six women in the top seven and 13 women among the top 20 candidates sends a strong signal that women are no longer merely increasing their numbers but are also excelling in terms of quality and competitive calibre.

A transformed terrain under the Yogi government

Before 2017, the Uttar Pradesh Public Service Commission (UPPSC) was often mired in multiple irregularities. Upon assuming office, Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath undertook several measures to streamline and strengthen the functioning of UPPSC and other recruitment bodies. These reforms enhanced the sanctity of examinations and restored candidates' confidence in the selection process.

Ananya Trivedi, who secured the second rank in the PCS-2024 examination, notes, "With the improvement in law and order under the Yogi government, female aspirants now have far greater freedom and space to pursue their goals. This is why the selection percentage of women is steadily increasing across examinations." A glance at the data from recent years substantiates this trend. Women's participation stood at 22.48 percent in PCS-2021, rose to 30.21 percent in 2022, and further increased to 33.46 percent in 2023. The figure reaching 34.22 percent in 2024 is clear evidence of the consistently rising participation and success of women.

This success cannot be viewed merely as an academic achievement; it is also a reflection of a shifting social mindset. Where once there were numerous barriers to girls' education, families are now actively encouraging them to pursue higher studies and prepare for competitive examinations. According to experts, improvements in girls' education, the availability of digital resources, and growing familial support under the Yogi government are key drivers of this change. Today, young women from small towns and rural regions are stepping forward and securing success in major competitive examinations—an undeniably positive and progressive sign.

Gender balance in the governance grid

The PCS-2024 results reveal that women have not only strengthened their numerical presence but have also secured a firm foothold in key positions. Among the 37 candidates selected for the prestigious post of Deputy Collector, 21 are women. This, in itself, marks a major shift, as women's representation in this role had remained relatively limited in previous years. Similarly, seven women have been selected out of 17 posts for Deputy SP. Their growing participation in a demanding domain such as law and order reflects their readiness to shoulder responsibilities across all sectors.

Women have also recorded remarkable success across other administrative positions. Out of 196 posts of Assistant Commissioner (Commercial Tax), 76 have been secured by women. In the case of Naib Tehsildar, 67 women have succeeded out of 258 posts. There has also been substantial participation of women in positions such as BDO, Treasury Officer, Social Welfare Officer, and others. This clearly indicates that gender balance within the administrative framework is steadily strengthening. A total of 947 posts have been filled in the PCS-2024 recruitment cycle, making it the largest selection drive since 2018. This will not only reinforce the administrative structure but also expand employment opportunities for the youth. The highest number of selections has been made for the post of Naib Tehsildar, with 258 appointments. In addition, large-scale recruitment has been carried out for 196 Assistant Commissioners (Commercial Tax), 142 Commercial Tax Officers, 72 BDOs, and 60 Deputy Jailors. This reflects the state government's sustained and systematic push to strengthen the administrative machinery through substantial recruitment.

Impact of government initiatives

Behind this success lies not only individual effort but also the impactful role of government initiatives and institutional support. Under the Yogi government's free coaching and guidance schemes, 45 candidates preparing for UPPCS-2024 have successfully cleared this prestigious examination. Among them, 35 candidates prepared at the Pre-Examination Training Centre located at Bhagirathi Bhawan in Lucknow and centres operating under